

Control4 Simple Device Discovery Protocol (SDDP) is a bit of software built into products to ensure seamless integration between the 50+ supporting manufacturers and partners. With SDDP, the system automatically finds and adds SDDP-enabled devices, thus making it far easier to add new elements of automation to your home.

Dimmers. It is the first thing that comes to mind when we talk about lighting. Controlling the brightness of your LED bulb is pretty simple and there are many low-cost drivers that can do it. But if you are really in it for quality, drivers like EcySystem LED driver from Lutron lets you continuously dim the brightness without any unsightly step-like dimming. Moreover, the driver lets you select from two types of dimming, namely, constant current reduction (CCR) or pulse width modulation (PWM).

Hue lighting system from Philips is a high-tech light bulb that lets you control colour, timing and brightness through a phone. You can go so far as to get it to simulate a sunrise in the morning.

Of course, just controlling the dimmer on an LED is not worthy of the home automation title. That is where light-management systems come into play.

Quantum Total Light Management System blends LED drivers, digital ballasts, motorised window shades and other lighting controls within one system.

Other systems like Lutron's EnergiSavr Node Solutions lets a smart system control light and save energy by controlling third-party ballasts, drivers, wired and wireless occupan-

Designed in India

THE-BUTTON. We are working on an interesting futuristic device that would be a small Wi-Fi based device called THE-BUTTON. It is a single-button-assignable action device that can be fitted in the house on prominent/specific places and would do the job when pressed. For example, if it is placed near a washing machine, it could be used to order a new batch of washing powder when you see that it is getting over. The same could be used as a distress-signal generator (to call for support), if placed near the main door or in the den.



—T. Anand, managing director, Knewron

Home automation smart plug (HASP). We have come up with HASP, a device that lets you transform your gadgets to achieve home automation. Paired with Bluetooth, an Android application is used to enter data to HASP which is then monitored by an inbuilt timer-controlled electronic switch that switches the device on or off according to the instruction given by the user via Android user interface.



—Edwin Andrews, co-founder, SPATEZ

cy sensors, daylight sensors and wall stations to efficiently manage light.

A motor controller like QS Motor Module can also be used to control natural lighting through AC blinds, shades and louvers.

Onset HOB0 occupancy and light-data loggers provide time-stamped occupancy and on/off light data. These can be used free of charge on qualifying projects. This should provide project managers and contractors with a competitive advantage and make the case for adding lighting controls to a project based on actual occupancy data.

Connection 2: The kitchen and the garden

Firms like Grahams Hi-Fi have been setting up lighting systems that connect with Web interfaces, time locks and even integrate with smoke detectors. So, if your beef steak just went from medium-rare to on-fire, the lighting system will show you the quickest way out of the room without

you getting suffocated, while the fire-control system takes care of the charred meat.

Systems from Honeywell will also have real people monitoring data from your home so that they can act in time in case of fire, a carbon-monoxide-related event or some other emergency.

Smart appliances. There is probably nothing cooler than Brewie, the world's first fully-automated home brewery. The system takes of everything from milling and mashing to adding hops and storing craft beer in kegs. It even lets you know when the brew is done as well as when it is ready for you to drink the brew or share it with your friends. It even cleans up after itself.

You can control your environment by using devices like Honeywell Lyric thermostat that let you adjust the temperature and control energy usage through the Internet or your smartphone. While Nest thermostat needs no specific mention, there are some new ones like iT500 by SALUS Controls for the European market and Ecobee 3.

For all those not-so-smart devices that you already have, you can use Incipio's series of smartplugs to give you complete smartphone control over these. You can use its fancy proximity-detection feature to turn on the PlayStation when you get

I automated my apartment and it kind of creeped me out

"A few weeks after I gave my apartment a home automation makeover, I found myself in a strictly 21st-century pickle. I was naked and shivering, stranded post-shower in my bathroom, trying to plot a route past a motion-activated camera to the freshly-laundried towels I had left by the bed. The camera was only meant to shoot pictures of trespassers, but the trigger that shuts off the system when I am home is my smartphone and I had allowed the battery to run down. From technology's point of view, I was an intruder in my own apartment."

—An excerpt from an article by Alexis SobelFitts at www.popularmechnics.com